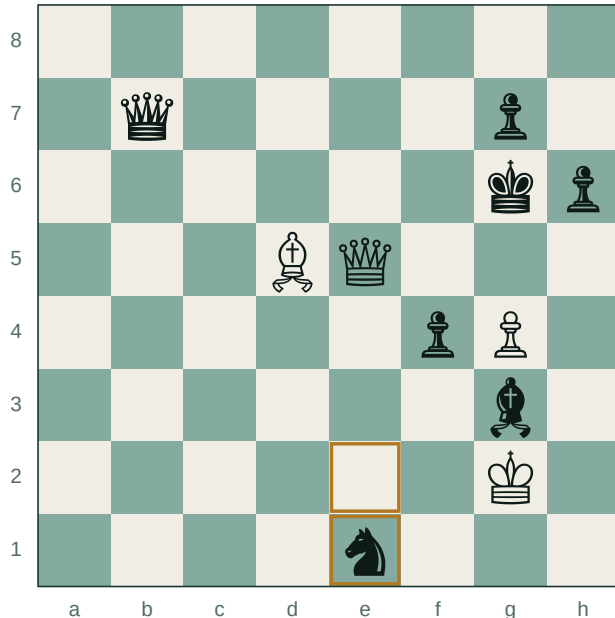


Active defensive resources: White, move 48

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 47...e1=N+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48. Kh3 Qxd5 49. Qxd5

48.Kh3 The king moves from g2 to h3. Recorded reply: **48...Qxd5**.

49.Qxd5 The queen captures the queen on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -5 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g6. Geometrically undefended: queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.